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Talk to Me, Goose!

Expression, Control, and Agency in Assistive Speech



Understanding ALS

- ALS can remove the ability to speak, **not thought or identity**
- Users have diverse physical abilities and access needs
- Communication depends on assistive technologies
 - Expression becomes **slower, effortful, and constrained**



Our Client & Product

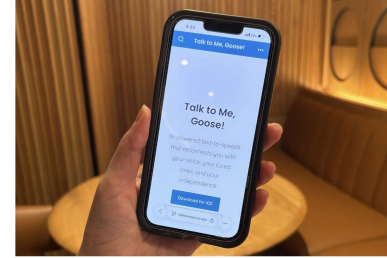
- Our client David built Talk to Me, Goose! after his ALS diagnosis to **preserve voice and self-expression**
- The app has grown in popularity and recognition, receiving the 2026 Zero Project Award and features on several local news stations

ENTREPRENEUR & BUSINESS PITTSBURGH

This app is using voice cloning to help people with speech loss sound like themselves again
Developed for people diagnosed with ALS, Talk to Me, Goose! turns short recordings into a text-to-speech tool that doesn't sound robotic.

Written by Alice Crow
JANUARY 3, 2026

Edited by Katie Malone



Talk to Me, Goose! offers text-to-speech services (Katie Malone/Technical3)



Pittsburgh man creates app to preserve his voice amid ALS battle

It's called "Talk to me, Goose"



Updated: 12:22 AM EDT Mar 13, 2026 | Editorial Standards ⓘ

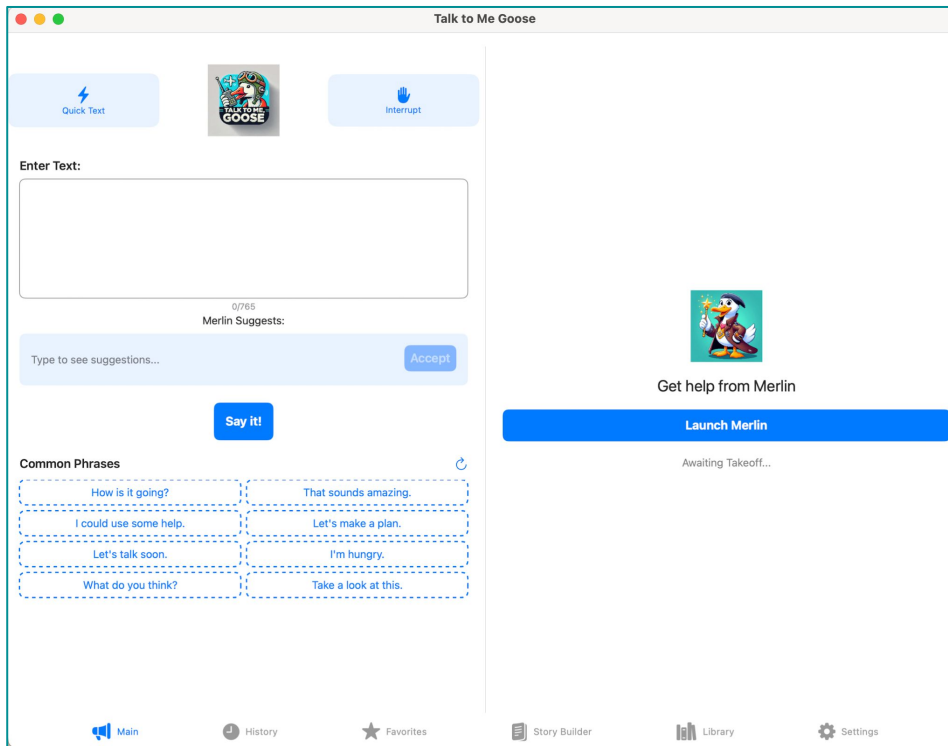
Design Process

Design Process - Round 1



Round 1 - Initial Evaluation

- Primary Researches
- Evaluated original Talk to Me, Goose in real-time AAC use



PROGRESS

This is not just a usability problem.

It's an *agency* problem.

Design Process - Round 1



Round 1 — Direction Setting

- Explored design opportunities and strategic directions
- Aligned on Safe & Confident Interaction
- Rebuilt interface, focused on tablet experience

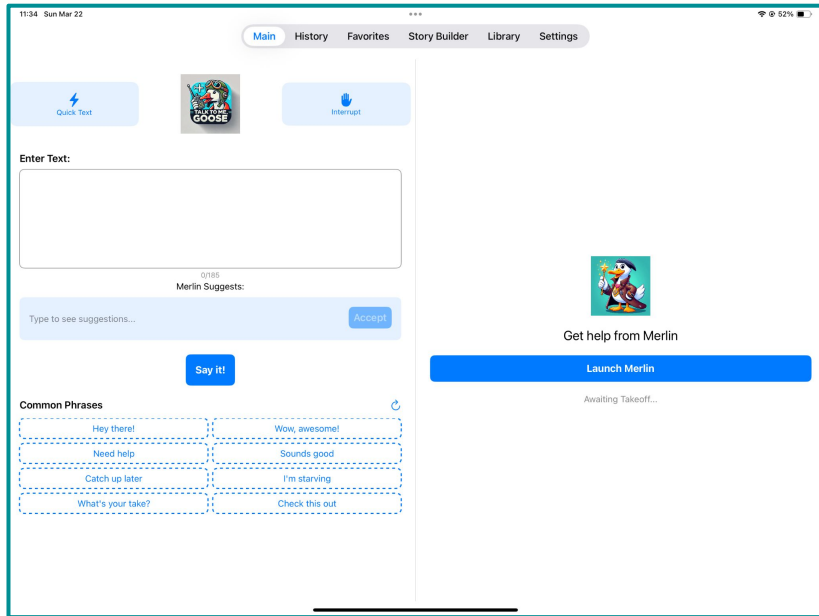


PROGRESS

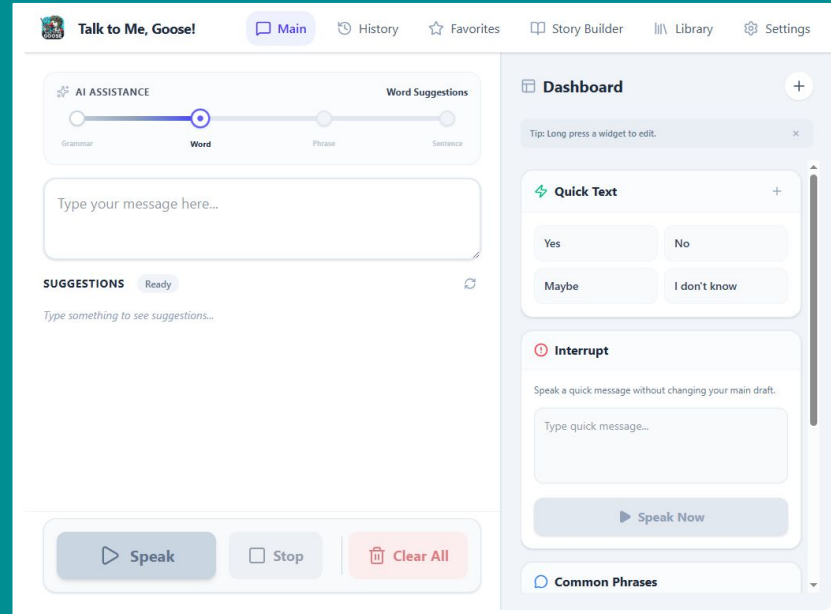


**Safe & Confident
Interaction**

Design Process - Round 2



Original



Mid-fi Prototype

Design Process - Round 2



Round 2 – Interface Testing

- Tested new interface + AI interaction
- Direction validated
- Revealed core UX gaps (clarity, interaction)

PROGRESS

This version is more
user friendly!

Task success
improved from
~63% to 100% !

It feels more
functional...!



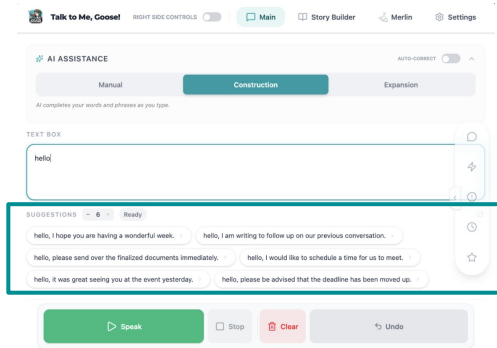
Design Process - Round 3



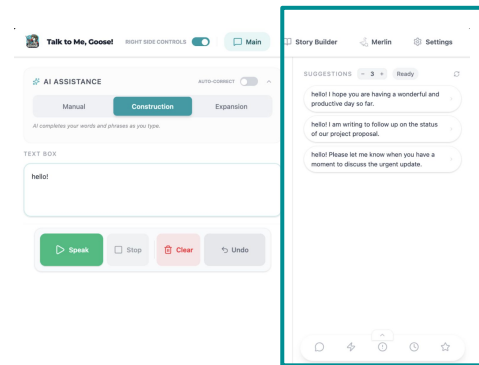
Round 3 – UX Validation

- Iterated on UX issues
- Collected quantitative data
- Confirmed improvements in design + layout

PROGRESS



VS.



Demo

Talk to Me, Goose! Redesign

Skit



Talk to Me, Goose! Redesign

User Validation

Research Design and Metrics

- Tested our prototype with 2 users with diagnosed ALS + 2 expert speech pathologists
 - Insight into accessibility-friendly design for ALS and other disabilities
- Quantitative metrics collected:

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N
	Participant ID	Task #	Did the user complete the task without help?	Did the user complete the task with prompting or assistance?	How much effort did user have to put in to complete the task? (1 - a lot of effort, 5 - no effort)	Task Duration (mm:ss)	User's Intended Message	Final System Message Created	Used mode as intended (1+ for AI modes, no suggestions for manual)	Did final message match user's intended verbal tone?	Does the final message stay on the same topic and reflect the user's overall intent?	Does the final message include all important details the user intended?	Final Expressivity Score (see comment for formula)	Did user use the expected widget
1	P1	1	☒	☐	5	2:05								
3	P1	3a	☒	☐	4	1:17	Claire, could you please get me a cup of water?	Claire, I would like some waters please	☒	☒	☒	☒	3	
4	P1	3b	☒	☐	4	0:40	Claire, could you please get me a cup of water?	Claire, could you get water? (didn't choose any)	☐	☐	☐	☐	0	
5	P1	3c	☒	☐	4	0:48	Claire, could you please get me a cup of water?	Error	☒	☐	☒	☒	2	
6	P1	4a - common phrases	☒	☐	5	0:38								☒
7	P1	4b - interrupt	☒	☐	5	1:17								☒
8	P1	4c - quick text	☒	☐	5	0:08								☒
9	P1	4d - history	☒	☐	5									☒
10	P1	5												
11	P1	6												

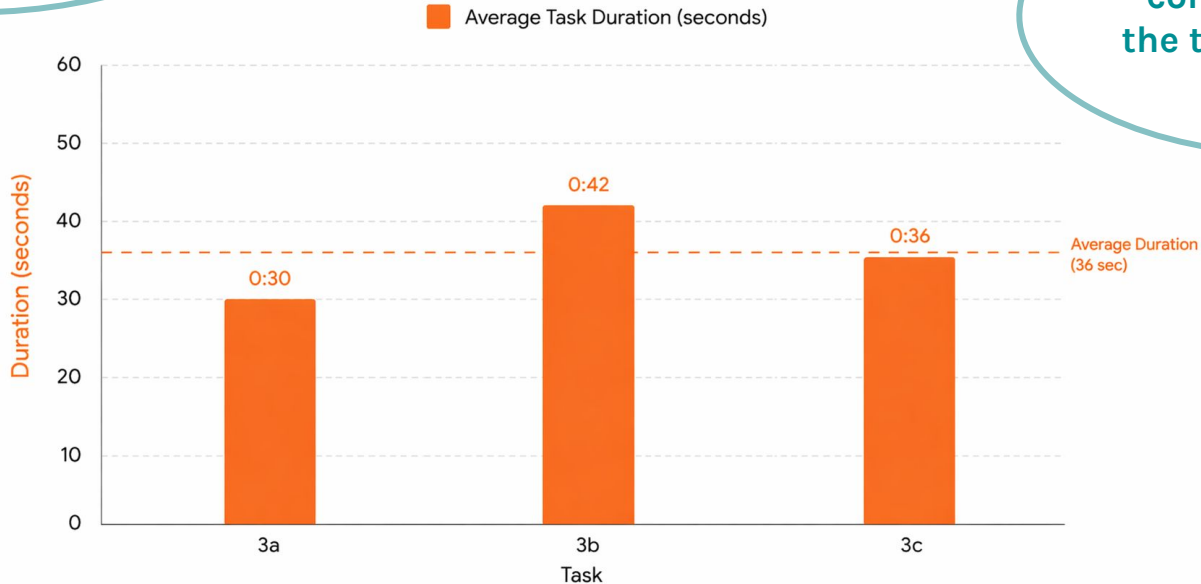
	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y
1	Task	Task Completion Rate (Independent or Assisted)	Independent Success Rate	Assisted Success Rate	Average Effort	Average Task Duration (seconds)	Task	Used Mode as Suggested Rate	Tone Rate	Meaning Rate	Completeness Rate	Average Expressivity Score	Task	Expected Widget Usage Rate	Layout	Count	Percentage	Assistance Mode	Count	Percentage
2	1	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	4.75	2:37	3a	100.00%	100.00%	100.00%	75.00%	2.75	4a	100.00%	Suggestions Below	3	75.00%	Manual	1	25
3	3a	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	4.75	0:30	3b	50.00%	25.00%	25.00%	0.00%	0.5	4b	100.00%	Right-Side Suggestions	1	25.00%	Construction	0	0
4	3b	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	3.75	0:42	3c	100.00%	75.00%	100.00%	75.00%	2.5	4c	100.00%				Expansion	3	75
5	3c	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	4.75	0:36							4d	100.00%						
6	4a	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	5	0:06														
7	4b	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	4.75	0:55														
8	4c	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	5	0:06														
9	4d	100.00%	100.00%	0.00%	4.75	0:11														
10																				
11																				



Positive Metrics and Feedback

100% unassisted
task completion
rate across all tasks

Average Task Duration (seconds)



Users used the
correct widget for
the task **100%** of the
time



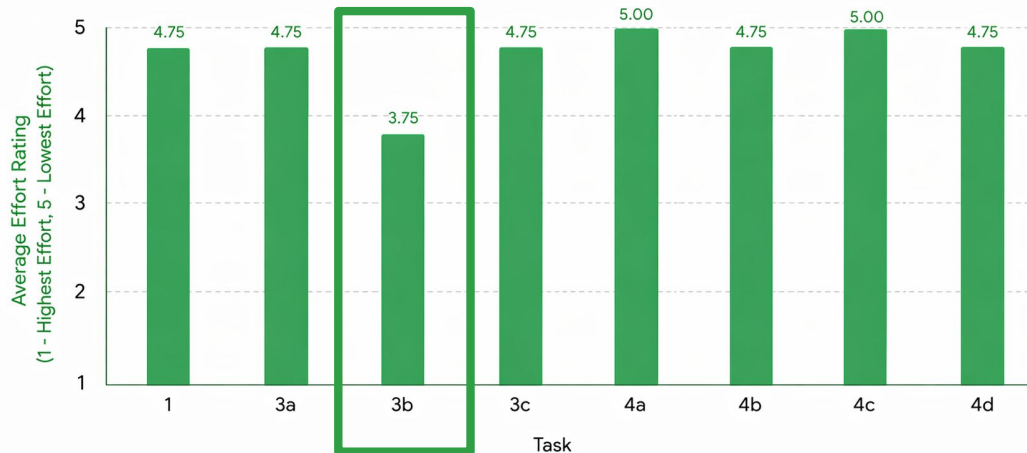
Areas for Improvement



Only **50%** used
Construction Mode
as intended

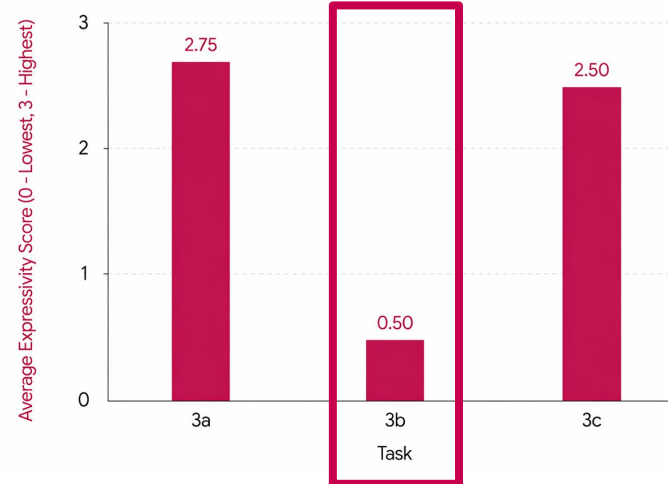
Average Effort per Task

■ Average Effort Rating (1 - Highest Effort, 5 - Lowest Effort)



Average Expressivity Score per Task

■ Average Expressivity Score (0 - Lowest, 3 - Highest)



Future Roadmap

Conclusion & Next Steps

The redesigned system improves clarity, control, and real-time usability, validating **Safe & Confident Interaction** as a strong foundation.

However, AAC use is highly contextual, and meaningful communication extends beyond a single setup or user group.



Expand across AAC Contexts



Technical Refinement of AI



Extend Prior Design Directions

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Expand across AAC Contexts



Technical Refinement of AI



Extend Prior Design Directions

Direction We Pursued



Lightweight
Expression



**Safe & Confident
Interaction**



Faster Than
Speech

Directions to Explore



Lightweight
Expression



**Safe & Confident
Interaction**



Faster Than
Speech

Why This Project Matters

1

person's vision

30K+

People live with ALS in the US
(CDC)

∞

potential reach



Thank You!